SSLC CLASS 10 ENGLISH - UNIT 3 NOTES

1. ANOTHER DAY IN PARADISE (PHIL COLLINS)

The song begins by painting a vivid and dismal picture of a homeless woman sitting in the freezing cold on a city street. She reaches out to a well-dressed male passerby, politely calling out to him for assistance by explaining that it is bitterly cold outside, she has nowhere to sleep, and she desperately needs guidance or shelter. Instead of responding with kindness or basic human compassion, the passerby chooses to pretend he cannot hear her distress. He immediately crosses the street, lowers his head, and hurries away, deliberately avoiding any eye contact or personal involvement with her tragic situation. As he walks away, he tries to dismiss the situation from his mind, attempting to convince himself that he has no obligation toward her and that it would be awkward or unnecessary to stop and help.

The narrative then highlights the extreme physical hardship and emotional isolation endured by the homeless woman. She is described as whistling or crying out softly in pain while trying to warm her bare feet against the pavement, as the soles of her shoes are completely worn through. Her face carries deep lines formed by constant suffering, hardship, and rejection. She has been forced to move continuously from place to place because society treats her as an outcast who simply does not fit in anywhere. Despite being repeatedly neglected and pushed aside by society, she continues her daily struggle to survive on the streets, demonstrating immense perseverance in the face of absolute despair.

Throughout the song, the recurring refrain serves as an urgent moral message addressed directly to the reader and society at large. The songwriter reminds us to think twice before ignoring the plight of the poor, pointing out that having a comfortable home, adequate food, warm clothing, and safety means living in a personal paradise. However, because fortunate people experience this comfort every day, they take it for granted and become blind to the intense suffering of marginalized individuals right in front of them. The title itself carries deep irony, contrasting the ordinary, peaceful day of a privileged citizen with the agonizing, survival-driven reality of a homeless person, leaving the audience with a troubling question about whether society will ever step forward to take meaningful action.